Argument Against Measure RM

Dear Neighbors and Friends,

This election asks one simple, but fundamental question: Who should choose our Mayor, you the Voters, or a majority of Politicians on the City Council? The people of South El Monte already answered that question by an overwhelming margin of 70%; you voted to have an elected Mayor. You decided that we cannot afford anymore backroom deals, political favors, and a rotating title handed out by whoever holds the council majority. Three councilmembers want to take that choice away from you.

This council majority has spent more energy trying to eliminate the office that the people elected than earning that office themselves. If they want to be Mayor, then they should have the courage to run for it, and face the voters, not change the rules because they cannot win under the current system. We have already seen what happens when politics come before accountability. The recent 3-2 council vote was disappointing, it showed exactly why concentrating the power to select the Mayor in the hands of a majority is a serious mistake.

An elected Mayor answers to every voter in the city, not just three colleagues. South El Monte deserves leaders who show up, work hard, attend community events, stay present in our neighborhoods, and always put residents and our city of South El Monte first, not their own political agenda.

Your support in this election is bigger than any single person. It is about protecting your vote, preserving your voice, choosing leaders who put you first, and keeping decision-making power where it belongs: with the people of South El Monte. Keep our right to vote and elect our Mayor. Please stand with us once again, vote No to a Rotating Mayor. Keep our elected Mayor accountable directly to you.

s/Gloria Olmos, Mayor of South El Monte
s/Manny Acosta, Councilman of South El Monte